

Lesson Objectives

- Explore the major drainage and water bodies of Canada.
- Study the relationships between drainage and watersheds.
- Learn about the hydrological make-up of the ecozones of Canada.
- Investigate sources of water pollution.
- Learn about the structure of Digital Elevation Models (DEM).
- Learn how to build a watershed mask in a GIS setting.
- Build multi-layer maps.
- Create a coloured relief map.
- Learn how to build a slope map from a DEM.
- Model changes in sea level due to climate change.
- Build a map layout.

Curriculum Expectations

The Ontario grade 9 curriculum expectations were used as a basis for preparing the lessons in this series. Although there is no direct correlation between Ontario expectations and other provinces, in general, the issues covered in the lessons do relate to many of the curriculum requirements in other jurisdictions. The full curriculum expectations can be found at the Ontario Ministry of Education Web site

English <http://www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/document/curricul/secondary/canadian/canaful.html>

French <http://www.edu.gov.on.ca/fr/document/curricul/secondary/canadian/canaful.html>

The performance tasks for Grade 9 Academic were based directly on curriculum expectations selected from the policy document for Canadian and World Studies. The tasks encompassed the four categories of knowledge and skills (i.e., Knowledge/Understanding, Thinking/Inquiry, Communication, and Application), requiring students to integrate their knowledge and skills in meaningful learning experiences.

The rubric for a specific performance task is intended to provide teachers and students with an overview of the expected final product with regard to the knowledge and skills being assessed as a whole. The rubric identifies key criteria by which the students' work is to be assessed, and it provides descriptions that indicate the degree to which the key criteria have been met. The teacher can use the descriptions of the different levels of achievement given in the rubric to assess student achievement on a particular task.